

IDFA FORUM 2026 — ENTRY DRAFT (v1, for Tomo's review)

Deadline: 25 July 2026, 23:59 CEST · entry fee €30 · professionals.idfa.nl › Markets ›

Enter your project

Forum: 15–18 Nov 2026, Amsterdam. Category: project in production seeking co-financing/co-production.

[TOMO] marks = fill or approve before submitting. Keep answers in this file; we paste into the portal together.

Project title: DEEP DIVE **Format:** Feature documentary, 90–100 min (companion 3×45' series in development) **Countries:** Croatia (majority) — seeking IT / HU / DE / FR minority partners **Languages:** Croatian, English, Hungarian, Italian **Stage:** In production — 2 of 7 shoot blocks completed · delivery Q4 2027 **Total budget:** €1,200,000 [TOMO: confirm envelope — plan allows up to 1.5M] **Financing in place:** €35,000 (producer's own investment, cash + in-kind to date) [TOMO: confirm figure] **Requested at Forum:** minority co-producers, broadcaster pre-sales (ARTE / ZDF / YLE / BBC Storyville), sales agent, funds

Logline (pick one)

1. Four best friends hold three of freediving's four absolute world records — and one documented injustice that tried to brand two of them cheats. A year in the deep with the people who go where humans shouldn't survive, and the hands that pull them back.
2. One person holds another in the world: the world's deepest man, his mentor who can stop breathing for half an hour, and the two women whose world record passed between best friends — a story of trust filmed at the edge of blackout.

[TOMO: instinct?]

Synopsis (~250 words — draft)

Petar Klovar dives deeper without fins than any human in history. His mentor Vitomir Maričić holds the Guinness record for the longest breath ever held — twenty-nine minutes — and studies his own physiology at the University of Rijeka's hyperbaric research centre. Sanda Delija was the first Croatian woman past a hundred metres; her free-immersion world record was taken, one metre at a time, by her best friend Zsófia Törőcsik — who three years ago had never freedived at all. Two couples, one mentor, one tight universe on the Croatian coast.

In 2023, at the sport's most famous competition, an airport luggage search — secretly filmed and posted online — branded Petar and Vito cheats. Their tests came back negative from a WADA-accredited lab; the international federation punished them anyway, through a three-page code of ethics. A peer-reviewed academic paper has since called the case procedurally and ethically wrong. In September 2026, the same world that tried to disgrace Vito will induct him into the International Sports Hall of Fame in Las Vegas — in the same class as Garry Kasparov.

DEEP DIVE follows all four across one year — from home water on Krk, through a world-record attempt under an erupting Etna that ended in a blackout and an open-eyed interview minutes later, to the deepest training camps of the Adriatic and the applause in Vegas. Above the surface the film is alive and moving; below it, sacred and still. It is not a film about depth. It is a film about who waits for you at the surface.

Director's statement (skeleton — [TOMO: voice pass])

- Why me: inside access nobody else has — a year of trust, the four as co-authors of their own hardest chapter (the 2023 working-paper method).
- The grammar: dynamic above the surface, sacred below. The cut between the two worlds is the film.
- The bets: the score built from their own physiology; one record dive in real time, unbroken; four voices braided into one descent monologue.
- The ethics: negative tests, an ethics-code punishment, a peer-reviewed rebuttal — rigour, never spectacle; their truth, on their terms, with veto over that chapter alone.

Production status (honest, specific)

- **Shot:** Krk (Apr–Jun 2026 — the four, families, home water, national championship) · Sicily (1–6 Jul 2026 — Petar's monofin world-record attempt ending in blackout + immediate interview; Mount Etna erupted during the shoot window — the film's opening image is in the can).
- **Ahead:** Lastovo depth camps 20 Jul–9 Aug (the sport laid bare; the deep 2023 conversations) · USA, 3 weeks around 26 Sept (ISHOF induction, Las Vegas; Vegas>San Francisco road trip; possible coda) · AIDA World Championships, Limassol 27 Sept–10 Oct (subject to athletes' schedule) · University of Rijeka hyperbaric lab (the science block) · coda night dive (bioluminescence).
- **Editing:** assembly from Nov 2026, rough cut spring 2027, lock summer 2027.

Finance plan (draft — [TOMO: adjust before submitting])

Source	Status	Amount
Producer's own investment (cash + in-kind)	secured	€35,000
Brand partners (dive industry + Croatian)	in negotiation	€75,000
HAVC production support	applying 10 Sept 2026	€50,000
HRT (Croatian broadcaster) pre-sale /co-production	in discussion	€40,000

Source	Status	Amount
Italian minority co-producer + funds	seeking (Forum)	€150,000
Hungarian minority co-producer + NFI	seeking (Forum)	€100,000
Eurimages (with co-producers attached)	2027 application	€280,000
Filming in Croatia rebate (25%+5% on HR spend incl. post)	eligible	€70,000
Broadcaster pre-sales / sales agent MG	seeking (Forum)	€400,000
Total		€1,200,000

Company & team

- **Production:** [TOMO: d.o.o. name — founding in progress, single owner Tomislav Kovačić]
- **Director/Producer:** Tomislav Kovačić — Croatian director & cinematographer; [TOMO: 2–3 line bio — commercial/branded work, production background, why this story found you]
- **Cinematography:** Tomislav Kovačić + 2-camera field unit (operators double as post team) [TOMO: names/credits]
- **Croatian co-producer:** in negotiation (shortlist prepared) — attach before Forum if possible
- Athletes' PR handled separately (Select PR) — film retains full editorial independence.

Materials checklist for the entry

- [] Sizzle/promo 3–5 min (Krk + Sicily + Etna) — private Vimeo link, password
- [] 2–3 stills per shoot block (the breath-up, the watchers, Etna over the sea)
- [] This document's fields pasted into portal
- [] €30 fee (card)
- [] Deadline guard: submit by **24 July** — never on deadline day.